

Processors

The powerhouse of any computer has remained one of the most popular product categories for the discerning. The latest crop of CPUs are also very exciting, promising a huge jump in performance over previous-generation architectures.

Best Buy: Rs 12,501 and above Intel Core i7 920

Intel's Core i7 920 is a renowned chip.

Renowned for bringing the price of the Core i7 close to what lesser mortals can afford. Sure, Rs. 14,500 is a lot of dough, but you get a lot of processor for that amount and one that is pretty future proof as well.



Best Buy: Up to Rs. 5,000 AMD Athlon II X2 250

Finally a win for AMD, as their X2 250 proves to be excellent value for money and a much better buy than all the Intel CPUs in that price range. It wins our Zero 1 Award for its blend of affordability and performance.



Best Performer Intel Core i7 975 Extreme Edition

Extreme indeed. Four, hyperthreaded cores running at 3.33 GHz is enough to send this monster skyrocketing ahead of the competition. No chip has amazed us as much since the Athlon 64 chips of old. Its price is in excess of Rs. 50,000 and it will not be the fastest CPU for much longer, with the new 32nm Intel products due next year. However, the fact that this chip runs cool, at a mere 50 degrees on load is testament to its pedigree and Intel's fabrication quality.

Best Buy: Rs. 5,001 to Rs. 12,500 Intel Core i5 750

A newcomer and one we were awaiting with bated breath. The Core i5 was touted to bring the goodness of performance at an affordable price and it has done that. Not only is it faster than the Q8400 by a good bit in terms of performance, it is also faster than Core 2 Quads — a worthy Zero 1 Award winner.

